

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Employee Leave, Approval & Performance Management Portal

Item	Details
Project Name	Employee Leave, Approval & Performance Management Portal
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Date	29th August 2026
Project Type	Web Application
Primary Users	Employees (incl. Reporting Managers), HR
Authentication	Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) — Single Sign-On
Hosting Environment	Microsoft Azure

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1. Document Information

1.1 Purpose of This Document

This Business Requirements Document (BRD) defines, without ambiguity, the business problem, proposed solution, in-scope and out-of-scope functionality, user roles, workflows, data requirements, security controls, timeline, budget, risks, and acceptance criteria of the Employee Leave, Approval & Performance Management Portal.

2. Executive Summary

The client has operated the company for five years and currently manages employee leave through email and spreadsheets. HR has reported that this process is slow, difficult to track, and gives no reliable visibility into who has applied for leave, how much leave each employee has remaining, or how consistently individual managers are approving requests.

The proposed portal will replace this manual process with a single web application with two distinct logins: an Employee login (used by all staff, including those who additionally hold reporting-manager responsibilities) and an HR login. Employees will submit leave requests, attach any supporting document (such as a forwarded email), and route the request to their assigned reporting manager. Once the manager approves, the request moves to HR for final approval. Approved leave updates the employee's leave balance automatically.

In addition to leave management, the portal will include a Performance & Feedback module, allowing reporting managers to set and review employee goals/objectives and record feedback, with HR having full visibility across the organization. All users will authenticate using their company Azure Active Directory credentials, and the system will be hosted on Microsoft Azure.

3. Business Background

The organization has been operating for approximately five years. Leave requests are currently communicated over email and tracked manually in spreadsheets by HR. As headcount has grown, this has become increasingly difficult to manage: requests are scattered across mailboxes, leave balances are updated manually and are prone to error, and HR has no consolidated way to see organization-wide leave activity or manager approval patterns.

HR has specifically asked for visibility into: how many employees have applied for leave, how many days a specific employee has remaining, and how many requests each manager is approving or rejecting. The client has also asked for a way to track employee performance (goals, objectives, and manager feedback) inside the same portal, so that HR has a single system for both leave and performance oversight.

4. Problem Statement

4.1 Primary Problem

Leave requests and approvals are handled through unstructured email threads and manually maintained spreadsheets, with no centralized, auditable workflow and no single source of truth for leave balances or approval activity.

4.2 Business Impact

- Delayed approvals due to manual follow-up between employees, managers, and HR
- Leave balances calculated and updated manually, with a risk of error

- No visibility for HR into organization-wide leave activity or manager approval behavior
- No system to track employee performance, goals, or manager feedback
- Employee records and history are scattered across email and spreadsheets rather than centralized

5. Proposed Solution

A centralized, Azure-hosted web application with two logins — Employee and HR — authenticated via Azure Active Directory. Any employee who is designated as a reporting manager in Azure AD will, upon logging in with their Employee login, automatically see an additional “Approvals” and “My Team” area reflecting their manager responsibilities. There is no separate manager login.

5.1 End-to-End Leave Workflow

Step	Actor	Action	System Outcome
1	Employee	Submits a leave request (dates, type, reason) and optionally attaches a supporting file (e.g. a forwarded email or screenshot)	Request created with status “Pending Manager Approval”; reporting manager notified
2	Reporting Manager (Employee login)	Reviews the request and its attachment, approves or rejects with optional comment	If approved: status → “Pending HR Approval”, HR notified. If rejected: status → “Rejected — Closed”, employee notified
3	HR	Performs final review and approves or rejects	If approved: status → “Approved”, leave balance deducted, employee notified. If rejected: status → “Rejected — Closed”, employee notified

6. Business Objectives

- Replace email/spreadsheet-based leave tracking with a single centralized workflow
- Give HR real-time visibility into pending requests, individual leave balances, and manager-wise approval statistics
- Reduce delays caused by manual follow-up between employees, managers, and HR
- Introduce a structured Performance & Feedback module for goals, objectives, and manager feedback
- Secure access using Azure Active Directory so employees log in with existing company credentials
- Maintain a complete, auditable history of leave and performance actions

7. Project Scope

7.1 In Scope

Area	Included Functionality
Authentication	Azure Active Directory login for all users; single sign-on
Roles	2 roles: Employee (default) and HR. Manager capabilities are enabled automatically for employees mapped as a reporting manager
Leave Requests	Submission, optional file attachment, manager approval, HR final approval, rejection at either stage
Leave Balances	Automatic tracking of allocated / used / remaining leave per employee, per leave type
Performance & Feedback	Goal/objective setting by managers, manager feedback entries, employee visibility into their own goals/feedback, HR visibility across all employees
Dashboards	Role-specific dashboards for Employee, Manager view (within Employee login), and HR
Notifications	In-app and/or email notifications at each workflow step
Audit & History	Full history of leave and performance actions with timestamps and actor identity

7.2 Out of Scope — Payroll and salary processing

- Recruitment / applicant tracking
- Biometric attendance integration
- Formal performance rating / appraisal-cycle workflows (e.g. annual rating calibration) — this covers goals and feedback entries, not a full appraisal cycle
- Mobile native application (web application is responsive but not a native app)
- Multi-level approval beyond Manager → HR (e.g. skip-level or department-head approval)

8. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role in Project	Primary Interest
Client / Business Owner	Final business approval	Overall business outcome and ROI
HR Department	Primary system administrator and end-user	Organization-wide visibility, accurate balances, performance data
Employees	End users	Simple self-service leave submission and status tracking
Reporting Managers	End users (via Employee login)	Fast approval workflow, team visibility, feedback tools
Project Team (Developer/Agency)	Delivery	Clear, testable requirements and timely feedback

9. User Roles & Permissions

Version this uses exactly two logins. There is no separate Manager login — manager capability is a permission layer applied automatically to an Employee login when that person is mapped as another employee's reporting manager in Azure AD.

Login	Who	Can Access
Employee	All staff (default view)	Own profile, own leave requests and balance, submit/track requests, own goals & feedback
Employee (with Manager permission)	Staff mapped as a reporting manager	Everything above, plus: pending approvals for direct reports, direct reports' leave history, set goals & give feedback for direct reports
HR	HR department staff	All employees' leave data and balances, all approval history, manager-wise approval statistics, all performance/feedback records, org-wide dashboards

10. Authentication & Access

10.1 Authentication

All users log in using their existing company Azure Active Directory credentials. The application will use Azure AD for single sign-on — there is no separate application password to manage.

10.2 Authorization

After authentication, access is restricted based on the user's assigned login type (Employee or HR) and, for Employees, whether they are mapped as a reporting manager. Employees cannot view another employee's leave, balance, or performance data except their own and, if a manager, their direct reports'.

11. Leave Request — Data & Field Requirements

Field	Required?	Notes
Employee ID / Name	Auto-filled	From logged-in AD profile
Leave Type	Required	Configurable list, e.g. Casual, Sick, Earned
Start Date / End Date	Required	System calculates number of days, excluding configured holidays/weekends
Reason	Required	Free text
Supporting Attachment	Optional	PDF/image upload, e.g. a forwarded email saved as a file
Manager Comment	Optional	Captured at manager approval/rejection step
HR Comment	Optional	Captured at HR approval/rejection step
Status	System-managed	Pending Manager → Pending HR → Approved / Rejected
Timestamps	System-managed	Submission, manager decision, HR decision

12. Leave Balance Management

The system maintains allocated, used, and remaining leave per employee per leave type, updated automatically when HR gives final approval. Employees can view their own balance at any time; HR can view and, where policy requires (e.g. year-start allocation, manual correction), adjust balances through an auditable admin action. No user can directly overwrite a balance value outside this controlled action.

Leave Type	Example Annual Allocation
Casual Leave	12 days
Sick Leave	10 days
Earned Leave	20 days

13. Performance & Feedback Module

This module gives reporting managers a structured way to set goals/objectives for their direct reports and record feedback, with HR holding full read visibility across the organization.

13.1 Manager Capabilities

- Create and edit goals/objectives for each direct report (title, description, target date, status)
- Record feedback entries against a direct report at any time (free text, dated)
- View a history of goals and feedback previously recorded for each direct report

13.2 Employee Capabilities

- View own goals/objectives and their current status
- View feedback recorded for them by their manager

13.3 HR Capabilities

- View goals, objectives, and feedback for every employee
- Filter/search by employee, manager, or department

14. HR Dashboard

- Total employees and employees currently on leave
- Pending leave requests (by stage: awaiting manager / awaiting HR)
- Individual employee leave balances
- Manager-wise approval and rejection statistics
- Department-wise leave statistics
- Organization-wide view of goals/feedback activity
- Search and filter by employee, manager, department, date, and status

15. Employee Dashboard (including Manager View)

15.1 Standard Employee View

- Current leave balance by type
- Apply for leave
- Status of submitted requests (pending/approved/rejected)
- Own goals, objectives, and feedback history

15.2 Additional Manager View (shown only to employees mapped as managers)

- Pending approvals for direct reports
- Team leave calendar (upcoming approved leave)
- Set/edit goals and record feedback for direct reports

16. Notifications

Event	Notification Sent To
Leave request submitted	Reporting Manager
Manager approves	HR
Manager rejects	Employee
HR approves	Employee
HR rejects	Employee
New goal/feedback recorded	Employee

17. Audit & History

The system will retain a complete, non-editable history of: who submitted each request, who approved/rejected it at each stage and when, all comments, all status changes, and all goal/feedback entries with author and timestamp.

18. Security Requirements

- Azure Active Directory authentication for all users
- Role-based authorization restricting data access per Section 9
- HTTPS/TLS for all traffic
- Uploaded attachments scanned/validated for type and size before storage
- Application secrets and credentials managed via Azure Key Vault
- Full audit logging of approval and performance actions

19. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Performance	Common actions (login, dashboard load, submit/approve request) respond within acceptable interactive time under expected usage
Availability	Application available to authorized users during business hours at minimum; no conflicting final statuses on the same request
Scalability	Architecture supports growth in employee count without redesign
Usability	Responsive web design usable on desktop and mobile browsers
Maintainability	Codebase and configuration documented for future support

20. Business Rules

- Only authenticated (Azure AD) users may access the system
- Manager review must occur before HR review; HR review only occurs after manager approval
- A manager rejection closes the request; it does not proceed to HR
- HR's decision is final
- Leave balance is deducted only after HR final approval
- An employee cannot approve their own leave request, even if they hold manager permissions
- All approval and performance actions are recorded in history and cannot be deleted by end users

21. Assumptions & Dependencies

21.1 Assumptions (to be confirmed by client before development starts)

- HR will confirm the final list of leave types and annual allocations
- Azure AD is already in use company-wide and the reporting-manager (or equivalent) attribute is populated, or HR will supply a maintained manager-mapping list
- HR will confirm accepted attachment file types and maximum file size
- HR will confirm whether a formal appraisal/rating cycle is needed now or can remain a future enhancement
- Client will provide timely feedback during weekly review checkpoints

21.2 Technical Dependencies

- Azure AD tenant access and app registration credentials
- Azure subscription for hosting, database, and storage
- Notification method (email service) confirmed during technical design

22. Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Azure AD manager attribute not populated/reliable	Confirm with HR during Week 1; fall back to HR-maintained mapping list

Risk	Mitigation
Scope creep on Performance module (rating/appraisal expectations)	Explicitly scoped to goals + feedback only; appraisal cycle listed as future enhancement
Unauthorized data access	Azure AD auth + role-based authorization, enforced server-side
Incorrect leave balances	Balance changes only via controlled, audited actions
Delayed stakeholder feedback	Weekly checkpoint reviews built into timeline

23. Success Criteria

- Employees can submit leave requests, attach supporting files, and track status end-to-end
- Managers (via Employee login) can approve/reject requests for direct reports
- HR can give final approval and has org-wide visibility into requests, balances, and manager-wise statistics
- Leave balances update automatically and accurately after HR approval
- Managers can set goals and record feedback; employees and HR can view it as defined in Section 13
- All users authenticate via Azure AD; no unauthorized cross-employee data access is possible
- Full audit history is available for every leave and performance action

24. Future Enhancements

- Formal appraisal / performance-rating cycle with scoring and calibration
- Multi-level or skip-level approval routing
- Native mobile application
- Payroll and attendance system integration
- Advanced analytics and custom reporting

25. Change Request Process

Any change to a requirement documented and approved in this BRD must be raised as a formal Change Request, describing the requested change, its business justification, and its impact on scope, timeline, and budget. No change will be implemented until it is reviewed and approved in writing by the Client/Business Owner.

26. Conclusion

This revised BRD removes the ambiguity present in the earlier draft by fixing the exact role model (two logins), the exact leave workflow, the exact meaning of the attachment requirement, the authentication method (Azure AD), and the scope of the Performance & Feedback module. It provides the agreed baseline for design, development, testing, and acceptance of Version this.

29. Business Requirements Approval & Sign-off

By signing below, the undersigned confirm they have reviewed and agree with the business problem, scope (Section 7), roles and workflow (Sections 9–11), Performance & Feedback module (Section 13), timeline (Section 22), and budget (Section 23) defined in this document for Version this. Any subsequent change follows the Change Request process (Section 27).

Stakeholder	Name / Designation	Signature	Date
Client / Business Owner			
HR Representative			
Project Manager / Agency			